

Higher -- Creed

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. Full board.

From *Human Clay* (1999), ~85 BPM.

Brian Marshall's part here follows the classic late-90s post-grunge shape -- moody, restrained verses building into a huge, driven "can you take me higher" chorus. Structurally this is close cousins with "Everlong" (same quiet-verse/huge-chorus alt-rock DNA), so this patch leans on the same AMP/DST/CAB recipe that build uses, rather than reinventing the wheel for a genuinely similar job.

CTL off = the restrained verse. CTL on = the big chorus.

GP-5 settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB.

NR -- Gate

- THRE: 24
- Always on. Moderate-high threshold -- the NAM below carries real grind, needs cleanup between notes.

PRE -- Micro Boost -- On CTL

- Gain: 58
- CTL off: bypassed (verse). CTL on: engaged (chorus).
- Verse stays restrained on its own. Chorus gets a clean push to match the song's own explosion in energy.

DST -- Bass OD, always on. Gain 63, Blend 75, VOL 62, Bass 55, Treble 58.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on. Gain 45, Bass 55, Middle 60, MidFreq 800Hz, Treble 60, VOL 65.

CAB -- User IR 3 (Apg810), always on. VOL 62.

- Bass OD plus Classic Bass together reproduce the grit this part needs.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1

- 33Hz: +3, 150Hz: 0, 600Hz: -2, 2kHz: +5, 8kHz: +3, VOL: 56
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- +5 at 2kHz and +3 at 8kHz keep this bright and present -- post-grunge choruses like this one are guitar-heavy and loud, this part needs real cut to stay heard. -2 at 600Hz keeps it from getting boxy under all that upper-mid push.

MOD -- Off

- No modulation. Straight-ahead post-grunge rock tone.

DLY -- Off

- Not used.

RVB -- Room -- On CTL

- Mix: 22, Decay: 36, Trail: On
- CTL off: bypassed (verse). CTL on: engaged (chorus).

- Verse stays tight and close. Chorus opens up with a touch of room to match the bigger, more anthemic space that section lives in.

AMP + DST: Classic Bass + Bass OD, CAB: Apg810 IR (User IR 3)

Rebuilt 2026-09-18 off the GP-5's own AMP/DST + a loaded IR -- NAMs are off for now (Valeton N->S volume issue, device-side). The old NAM was a Darkglass B7K Ultra (Gain 60) -- modern, punchy drive/preamp character, exactly the territory late-90s post-grunge choruses live in, same reasoning that made it the right call for "Everlong." Classic Bass + an always-on Bass OD reproduce that grind; Apg810 is the direct SVT-family cab pairing. Middle and Treble kept up on both stages to keep the part cutting through the guitars.

CTL summary

- **CTL Off -- Verse.** Restrained, moody, dry. Sitting back with the vocal.
- **CTL On -- Chorus.** Boost and room reverb engage together. Bigger, more open, matching the song's own explosion in energy.
- Engage CTL right as the "can you take me higher" chorus hits, disengage back into the next verse.

Full pedalboard (signal chain order)

1. Flamma FS-08 Octave -- Bypassed

- Footswitch off. No octave layering -- this part tracks the song's dynamics directly, an octave stack would clutter that.

2. Donner Ultimate Comp -- Engaged

- COMP: 52
- TONE: 60
- LEVEL: 58
- Mode: TREBLE
- Keeps the verse-to-chorus dynamics consistent within each section. TREBLE mode keeps pick/finger attack bright and audible before it hits the NAM's own drive stage.

3. Donner Stylish Fuzz -- Bypassed

- Footswitch off. The NAM's own drive already covers the grit this song needs -- a fuzz stacked on top would just mud things out.

4. Joyo Tidal Wave -- Bypassed

- Footswitch off, Drive/Blend not engaged. Same reasoning -- one drive source (the NAM) is enough.

5. Joyo Narcissus -- Bypassed

- Footswitch off. No chorus -- matches the MOD-off call on the GP-5. Straight-ahead rock tone throughout.

6. Valeton GP-5 -- see settings above.